LCOY NEPAL 2026

"Together for Climate Transparency"

LCOY NEPAL 2026 EVENT REPORT

14, 15 & 16 August 2026
Anupam Foodland, Battisputali, Kathmandu, Nepal



Prepared By
Nepalese Youth for Climate Action (NYCA)
Youth Action for Sustainable and Eco Nepal (YASEN)

officially endorsed by LCOY | a project of YOUNGO

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1. Remarks from the Focal Points

It is a privilege to present this report on the **Local Conference of Youth (LCOY) Nepal 2026.** Over three days in Kathmandu, young people from all seven provinces came together not to repeat what they had read about climate change, but to put on record what they had lived through: schools shut for two weeks by heat in Madhesh, a bridge collapsing in Kathmandu, water sources drying in Bardiya, springs disappearing in Kavre, a family in Pokhara losing its home to flash floods and many more.

The theme we chose this year, **"Together for Climate Transparency"**, was deliberate. Nepal is not short of climate commitments. What has been missing is the ability of ordinary people, and young people in particular, to see what is promised, what is funded, what is delivered and what is still missing. Transparency is what turns a grievance into evidence, and evidence into accountability. That idea ran through every session, from the glacier data presented by ICIMOD to the delegate who asked why there was no child on the panel answering questions about children.

This report captures what was said, who said it, and what young people asked the state to do about it. It records the sessions, the workshops, the disagreements and the recommendations that became the **National Children and Youth Statement on Climate Change 2026**. It is not a souvenir. It is a working document, and its usefulness depends entirely on what happens after it is published.

We are grateful to every delegate, speaker, facilitator, partner and volunteer who gave time to this event. The National Children and Youth Statement produced here now travels to the Government of Nepal and to COP 31 in Antalya, Türkiye. Whether it changes anything or not depends on all of us continuing to push after the hall empties.

Ganesh Paudel & Aakriti Dotel
Focal Points
LCOY Nepal 2026

2. Executive Summary

Nepal contributes a negligible share of global greenhouse gas emissions and carries a disproportionate share of the consequences. National temperature is rising by roughly 0.056 degrees Celsius per year, with the rate crossing the 0.1 threshold in the mountain region. Fifty of Nepal's seventy-seven districts are classified as high to very high vulnerability. Between 1996 and 2019, an average of 619 people died each year from climate-related impacts, and roughly 70 percent of those impacts were flood-induced. On a single day in August 2026, the temperature in Nepalgunj stood at 45 degrees Celsius while Namche recorded 12.

LCOY Nepal 2026 brought delegates from all seven provinces to Kathmandu from 14 to 16 August 2026 under the theme "Together for Climate Transparency". The conference was organized by Nepalese Youth for Climate Action (NYCA) and Youth Action for Sustainable and Eco Nepal (YASEN), with endorsement from YOUNGO. It followed nine virtual consultations that gathered climate concerns and recommendations from around 180 delegates before the residential event began.

The programme was built around seven thematic pillars: youth and children's engagement in climate processes; loss and damage, climate finance and just transition; changing mountains and livelihoods; climate resilient education systems and Action for Climate Empowerment; agriculture, food security and nutrition; WASH and water security; and children, youth and GEDSI. Across three days, delegates attended plenary sessions, keynotes, dedicated thematic sessions, a mock COP negotiation, a people's hearing on climate justice, a climate finance pitching workshop, a province-wise grassroots case study exercise, and structured group work on Nepal's National Climate Change Policy 2019 and collectively drafted the National Children and Youth Statement on Climate Change.

The conference was opened by the Honourable Minister for Agriculture, Forests and Environment, Geeta Chaudhary, who committed to carrying youth voices into every stage of policy and to COP 31. Speakers included representatives of MoAFE, MoES, the Department of Water Supply and Sewerage Management, UNICEF Nepal, WWF Nepal, ICIMOD, Clean Energy Nepal, Prakriti Resource Centre, Plan International Nepal, Forest Action, IWMI, YUWA, WOREC, BYAN, World Food Forum Nepal, Welthungerhilfe and Practical Action Nepal.

The central output is the National Children and Youth Statement on Climate Change 2026, consolidating delegate recommendations for submission to the Government of Nepal, for use in the review of the National Climate Change Policy 2019, and for transmission to YOUNGO for the Global Youth Statement ahead of COP 31 in Antalya, Türkiye.

Two demands surfaced in almost every session. First, that children and youth participation stop being tokenistic: delegates repeatedly distinguish between being counted and being consulted, and asked to be present in planning and problem-solving rather than invited as observers and advisors. Second, that transparency be treated as infrastructure rather than a slogan, with accessible data on climate finance flows, project results and local budget allocation. As one panelist put it during the transparency session, youth are not an audience, they are an accountability force.

3. About LCOY Nepal 2026

The Local Conference of Youth is a national event endorsed by YOUNGO, the official children and youth constituency of the UNFCCC. LCOYs feed into the global Conference of Youth (COY) and, through it, into the Conference of the Parties. They exist because only a small number of young people can attend global negotiations in person, and a national platform is needed to build positions that those few delegates can carry.

Nepal has hosted an LCOY every year since 2022. LCOY Nepal 2022 was held virtually and engaged more than 60 young people directly and over 2,000 indirectly. LCOY Nepal 2023, themed "Vision to Action", brought together participants from all seven provinces with more than half of them women. LCOY Nepal 2024, organised by YASEN and Sustainability Week Kathmandu under the theme "From Local to Global", convened 190 participants and focused on NDCs, loss and damage and indigenous knowledge. LCOY Nepal 2025, led by Powershift Nepal with partners, engaged around 500 children and young people through virtual, provincial and national events and produced a statement that fed into Nepal's COP 30 priorities and YOUNGO's Global Youth Statement.

LCOY Nepal 2026 was held as a three-day residential conference at Anupam Foodland, Battisputali, Kathmandu, on 14, 15 and 16 August 2026. It was open to children and youth aged 10 to 30, with priority given to marginalised, indigenous and ethnic communities, differently-abled individuals, children, women and those directly affected by climate and social adversity. A minimum of 50 percent women and gender-diverse participation was applied to the selection process ensuring that inclusion and equitable representation remained a significant consideration throughout the conference.

The theme, "Together for Climate Transparency", was introduced by the focal point at the opening plenary. Transparency was framed as three things at once: honesty about what is happening on the ground, correct and shared information about what is being promised and spent, and a guarantee that every voice in the room reaches the table where decisions are made.



4. About the Organizers

LCOY Nepal 2026 was hosted organizations that brought complementary strengths to the event, combining NYCA's well-established national and international climate network and strong provincial chapter structure with YASEN's grassroots community engagement and practical experience in organising and delivering LCOY Nepal 2024. This partnership brought together national reach and local expertise, strengthening the outreach, coordination, and inclusive participation of young people throughout the LCOY Nepal 2026 process.

Nepalese Youth for Climate Action (NYCA)
NYCA is a youth-led coalition of Nepalese youth and youth groups established on 10 August 2008, with the motto "Caring for Climate, Caring for Ourselves". NYCA works to protect Nepal and its people from the adverse impacts of climate change through awareness, policy advocacy and a nationwide youth movement. It collaborates with universities, schools, organisations and communities at local, national and international levels, has active chapters across all seven provinces, and its secretariat is hosted by Clean Energy Nepal.
Website: ***nyca.net.np***

Youth Action for Sustainable and Eco Nepal (YASEN)
YASEN is a youth-led non-profit organization established on 27 March 2023, with the motto "Empowering the Younger Generation Towards a Sustainable Future". YASEN works on community education and awareness, recycling and waste reduction, capacity building and training, climate action, women's empowerment and entrepreneurship, loss and damage, sustainable agriculture and disaster risk reduction. It currently works with a team of over 100 youth representing diverse cultures and traditions across all seven provinces.
Website: ***yasennepal.org***

Youth Action for Sustainable and Eco Nepal (YASEN)

5. Objectives

The general objective of LCOY Nepal 2026 was to strengthen the capacity, leadership and advocacy of Nepalese children and youth in climate governance, climate justice and meaningful participation in national and international climate processes.

The specific objectives were:

- To strengthen knowledge and leadership among Nepalese children and youth on climate governance and international climate processes, including the UNFCCC and COP mechanisms.
- To empower children and youth to advocate for just and equitable climate action, embedding a human rights agenda in the climate discourse, including accessible loss and damage mechanisms, climate finance and just transition frameworks.
- To build understanding and capacity on climate-resilient education, WASH and food systems at national and subnational levels.
- To amplify mountain and indigenous knowledge and draw stakeholder attention to the impacts of climate change on Nepal's mountain ecosystems, rural livelihoods and cultural heritage.
- To promote youth-led awareness and innovation, including the use of artificial intelligence and remote sensing, integrating local, indigenous and science-based knowledge.
- To promote GEDSI in climate governance and action at national and international level.
- To review the National Climate Change Policy 2019 from a children and youth perspective and to formulate the National Children and Youth Statement on Climate Change 2026 for submission to the Government of Nepal and relevant international bodies.

6. Thematic Areas

LCOY Nepal 2026 was structured around seven interconnected thematic pillars, which were:

Youth and Children Engagement in Climate Processes: Building delegates' understanding of the UNFCCC process, Nepal's NDCs and the National Climate Change Policy 2019, and creating pathways for youth advocacy. Includes the call for the Government of Nepal to sign the Children, Youth and Climate Action Declaration made at COP 25 in Madrid.

Loss and Damage, Climate Finance and Just Transition: Nepal's climate-induced losses, from melting glaciers to crop failure, and the country's access to the Loss and Damage Fund, the Green Climate Fund and the Global Environment Facility, alongside the question of what makes an energy transition just for workers, indigenous peoples and marginalised groups.

Changing Mountains and Livelihoods: Shrinking glaciers, shifting treelines, altered river regimes, glacial lake outburst floods, and the downstream consequences for rural livelihoods and cultural heritage.

Climate Resilient Education System and Action for Climate Empowerment (ACE): Safe and green school infrastructure, learning continuity during disasters, climate literacy, green skills and the role of youth in ACE.

Agriculture, Food Security and Nutrition: Climate-resilient food systems, the disruption of production chains, indigenous agricultural practice, and the health and ecological consequences of chemical-intensive agriculture.

WASH and Water Security: Drying springs, contaminated sources after floods, failing sanitation infrastructure, and the advocacy skills needed to push for climate-resilient WASH systems at every level of governance.

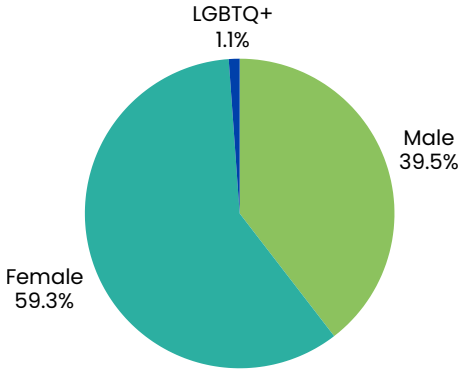
Children, Youth and GEDSI: Ensuring the meaningful participation and leadership of women, young girls, persons with disabilities, indigenous peoples, Dalits, Madhesi, LGBTQIA+ individuals and other marginalised communities in climate governance.

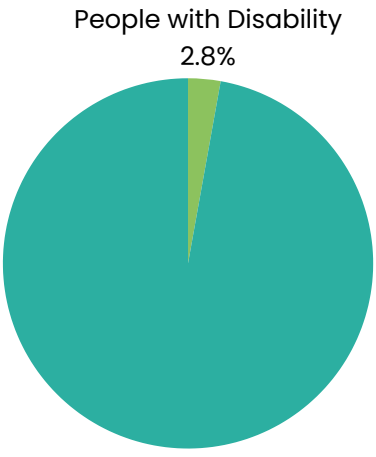
7. Delegates' Socio-Demographic Profile

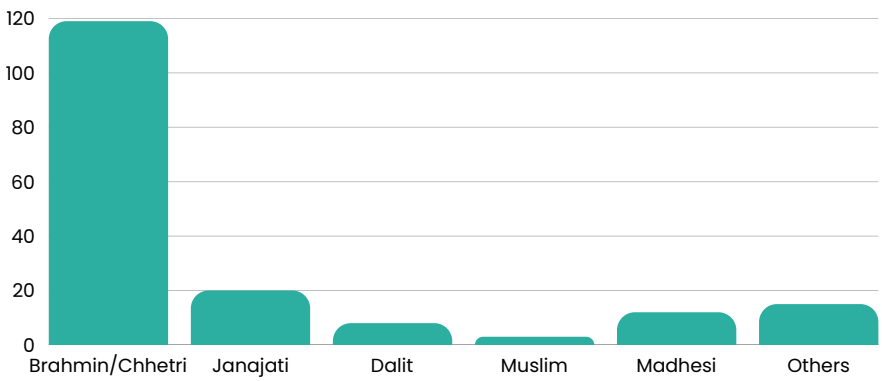
Selection was designed around representation rather than volume. The principles applied were:

- Representation from all seven provinces, with priority to indigenous, marginalised, socially excluded, differently-abled, and rural communities.
- Women and gender-diverse participants represented 60.4% of the total delegates.
- Dedicated slots for school children, alongside youth delegates, so that the "children" in the National Children and Youth Statement were physically present.
- Funding tiers divided into fully funded, partially funded and self-funded delegates, with fully funded slots prioritised for those who could not otherwise attend.
- Slots reserved for delegates with no prior involvement in environmental activism, to widen the pool beyond the existing climate circuit.
- Dedicated guest slots for professionals working in climate change, indigenous knowledge systems, environmental conservation and journalism.

Children from Creative Academy participated alongside youth delegates in plenary and parallel sessions. Delegates chose their parallel sessions through an allocation form circulated before the event.







8. Methodology and Roadmap

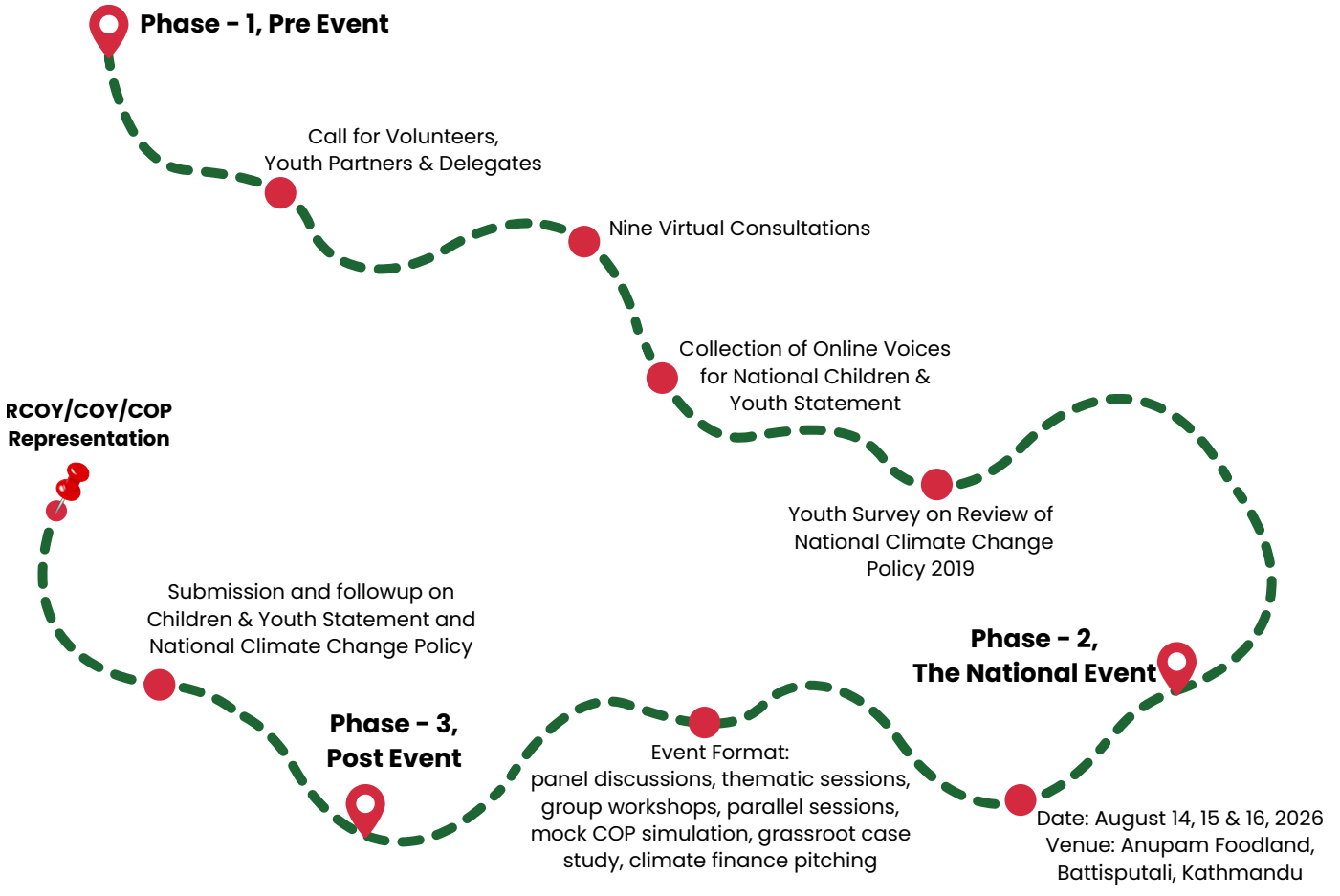
LCOY Nepal 2026 followed a three-phase design, that includes:

Phase 1, pre-event. Nine virtual consultations were held across the thematic areas to build baseline knowledge before delegates arrived, alongside a review of national climate policies and the collection of climate concerns, experiences and recommendations from around 180 delegates. Consultations with women-led, disability-led, indigenous and marginalised youth groups were held to identify climate challenges and policy priorities from a GEDSI perspective. Digital outreach and a nationwide call handled delegate selection and the recruitment of youth partners and organising committee members.

Phase 2, the national event. Three days at Anupam Foodland, combining plenary keynotes, panel discussions, parallel thematic sessions, group workshops, a mock COP simulation, a people's hearing, a climate finance pitching workshop, energizers, cultural night and networking sessions. Notes were taken in every session by a designated two-person note-taking team, rotated daily, which forms the evidence base for this report.

Phase 3, post-event. Formal submission of the National Children and Youth Statement, presentation at national climate consultations, publication of this report, continued digital engagement with delegates, and monitoring against the indicators set out in section 17.

LCOY Nepal 2026 RoadMap



9. Pre-Event Virtual Consultations

Nine virtual consultations were held from 5–30 July 2026, engaging more than 280 young people ahead of the residential conference. The sessions built delegates' baseline understanding of climate governance and generated locally grounded climate concerns, allowing the Kathmandu programme to focus on deeper discussion and drafting.

The series covered youth engagement, human rights and climate justice, water security, disability inclusion, climate finance, energy transition, loss and damage, rangelands, agrifood systems and Nepal's climate policies. Each session combined technical presentations with interactive discussions and breakout groups, strengthening delegates' capacity for meaningful participation during the three-day conference.

S.N.	Session	Date	Speakers and moderator	Participants
1	Road to LCOY, RCOY, COY and COP	Jul 5, 2026	Speaker: Dikshya Subedi Moderator: Sindhu Sharma	93
2	Climate Justice for Persons with Disabilities: Understanding Risks and Inclusive Action	Jul 12, 2026	Speaker: Jaldeep Sapkota (BYAN) Moderator: Aaska Aryal	170
3	Unpacking Climate Change: Connecting Loss and Damage, Climate Finance, Just Transition and SRHR	Jul 17, 2026	Speakers: Tejaswee Bhattarai (YUWA), Yam Kumari Uchai (PRC), Suvekcchya Tuladhar (PRC), Sneha Rai (PRC). Moderator: Pramila B.K.	241
4	The ICJ Advisory Opinion on Climate Change, Policy to Practice, and Agrifood Systems	Jul 18, 2026	Speakers: Adv. Prajwol Bikram Rana (WYCJ), Anubhav Ghimire (Resilience Labs), Pragya Devkota (WFF Nepal). Moderator: Kritika Khatiwada.	260
5	Youth for Water Security and Climate-Resilient WASH	Jul 22, 2026	Speakers: Arinita Maskey Shrestha (UNICEF), Ashmita Shrestha (Paschim Paila). Moderator: Bindu Shrestha.	230
6	Rangeland and Pastoralism in the Mountains	Jul 23, 2026	Speakers: Ramesh Timilsina (ICIMOD), Keshav Bhatta, Tulasa Chaudhary, Uma Dhungel (GIIS). Host: Kritika Laudari.	230
7	Linkage Between Climate Change and Human Rights	Jul 25, 2026	Speaker: Kundan Raj Sharma. Moderator: Nischal Raj Gautam.	180
8	National Pathways for Food Systems Transformation	Jul 29, 2026	Speaker: Sharmila Pun (Welthungerhilfe Nepal). Moderator: Shristika Pandey.	179
9	Climate-Smart and Resilient Education Systems	Jul 30, 2026	Speakers: Dr Shyam Prasad Acharya, Sita Maya Bomjam, Bibek Pant. Moderator: Nischal Dhungana.	207

10. Program and Activities | Day 1, 14 August 2026

The first day was built to bring every delegate to a common baseline: what the climate policy architecture is, what the science says about Nepal's mountains and rivers, and where children and youth currently sit in that architecture. Emcees Hemant Kandel and Pramila B.K. opened the proceedings, followed by the national anthem and a minute of silence for lives lost to climate-induced disasters.

10.1 Opening Plenary

Jyanti Bam - UNICEF Youth Advocate: Jyanti Bam, a UNICEF Youth Advocate and Class 10 student, opened the conference by reminding delegates that climate change is no longer a textbook topic but a daily reality, disproportionately affecting children and other vulnerable groups. Speaking for children across Nepal, she questioned whether climate finance and programmes are reaching children on the ground and stressed that climate action must meaningfully include them.





Aakriti Dotel — Focal Point, LCOY Nepal 2026: Aakriti Dotel, Focal Point of LCOY Nepal 2026, introduced LCOY as YOUNGO's official platform for youth engagement in climate processes. She highlighted the conference's focus on strengthening youth leadership, reviewing policies, gathering grassroots concerns, finalising the National Youth Statement and ensuring meaningful youth participation in decision-making.

Jee Hyun Rah — UNICEF Nepal: Jee Hyun Rah, UNICEF Representative, emphasised that climate change is both a child rights and human rights issue, with children contributing least while facing some of its greatest impacts. She recognised young people as leaders and changemakers and reaffirmed UNICEF's continued partnership and support for youth-led climate action in Nepal.





Dr. Ghanashyam Gurung — WWF Nepal: Dr. Ghanashyam Gurung, WWF Nepal Country Representative, stressed that climate change affects people unequally and that resilience depends on who people are and where they live. He urged delegates to recognise their potential beyond numerical participation and connect climate action with everyday food systems and consumption.

Shakeb Nabi — Welthungerhilfe (WHH) Nepal: Shakeb Nabi highlighted climate change as a pressing issue affecting everyday life and appreciated young people across Nepal for raising their voices and taking action. He encouraged youth to connect grassroots action with policy engagement so that their concerns reach decision-making spaces.





Dr Krishna Prasad Poudel - Forest Action: Dr. Krishna Prasad Poudel connected the climate crisis to human consumption, lifestyles and food systems, arguing that climate action must begin with how we live and what we eat. He challenged delegates to question both their food choices and whether policies discussed at conferences are being implemented on the ground.

Maheshwor Dhakal, MoAFE: Maheshwor Dhakal encouraged delegates to use LCOY for networking, collaboration and interpersonal skill development while strengthening youth engagement in climate policy. He highlighted Common But Differentiated Responsibilities, the need to connect climate finance with local action, and stronger youth coordination ahead of COP31.





Honourable Minister Geeta Chaudhary — Chief Guest: Hon. Minister Geeta Chaudhary highlighted Nepal's vulnerability to climate impacts, including melting ice, landslides and floods affecting livelihoods, agriculture and forests. She committed to bringing youth voices into policy processes and COP31, invited delegates to contribute their findings to policy discussions, and reaffirmed the government's commitment to inclusive climate action and green jobs.

Ganesh Paudel — Chair & Focal Point, LCOY Nepal 2026: Ganesh Paudel emphasised that climate change cannot be addressed by one person, group or ministry alone, making transparency, accurate information and inclusive participation essential. He outlined the three-day programme and stressed that LCOY belongs to young people, with their National Youth Statement feeding into national policymaking and COP31.



10.2 Panel Session: Ambition to Action Children and Youth at the Centre of Climate Policy, NAP and NDC

Moderators: Kirtan Pandit and Roshani Shah (child)
Keynote Speaker: Shreya K.C., Clean Energy Nepal
Panelists: Sanju Lamichhane, Department of Water Supply and Sewerage Management; Shankar Adhikari, Ministry of Education and Sports; Rita Thapa, Youth Climate Governance Network



The panel discussion focused on strengthening the implementation of Nepal's climate policies, particularly the NDC and NAP, with children and youth meaningfully engaged in climate governance. Key areas of discussion included climate-responsive education, meaningful youth participation, climate-resilient planning, WASH, and stronger links between policy and local implementation. The discussion also highlighted gaps in climate-related research and innovation, particularly limited research grants and innovation funding for universities, and emphasised stronger collaboration between government, universities and technical institutions.

Shreya K.C. — Keynote, Clean Energy Nepal: Shreya K.C. highlighted that climate change has evolved from a long-term concern into an immediate crisis affecting communities, livelihoods and daily life. She emphasised that youth participation should move beyond symbolic representation towards meaningful involvement in decision-making, supported by resources, capacity building, mentorship and trust. She further noted that the effectiveness of the NDC and NAP depends on their implementation at the local level in collaboration with communities and young people.

Shankar Adhikari — Ministry of Education and Sports: Shankar Adhikari highlighted the need to integrate climate change across the education system, including curricula, school infrastructure, drinking water, green skills and practical learning. He emphasised experiential approaches such as project work, field visits, school gardens and plantation activities, alongside stronger teacher capacity and emergency education planning. He also highlighted the potential of vocational and technical education and called for child and eco clubs to function as meaningful platforms for learning and action.



Rita Thapa - Youth Climate Governance Network: Rita Thapa highlighted the need for youth to be involved not only as participants but also in climate planning, problem-solving and follow-up processes. She shared YCGN's experience of engaging youth representatives from all seven provinces and noted that 22 youth priorities were incorporated into the final NDC through its consultation process. She also highlighted opportunities for youth and eco clubs to access local government resources and called for stronger capacity building and coordination among government, UN agencies, civil society and youth networks.

Sanju Lamichhane - Department of Water Supply and Sewerage Management: Sanju Lamichhane highlighted the importance of grounding climate planning in localized analysis to understand specific climate impacts, while noting that limited resources remain a key gap. She emphasized the need for design analysis and emergency response planning across all offices, along with multi-stakeholder communication on WASH, sanitation, and water issues. She also stressed the importance of involving children in these processes from the very beginning.

10.3 **Parallel Sessions:**

Session 1: Securing Water for Our Future — Local Water Conservation and Climate-Resilient WASH

Facilitators: Asmita Shrestha and Paschim Paila, with support from Arinita Maskey Shrestha and Aakanshya Gahatraj Sunar (UNICEF Nepal), Jibesh KC (IWMI), and contributions from Sunita Budha and Buddha Bajracharya.

The session explored water security, local water conservation, and climate-resilient WASH through technical inputs, local experiences, and practical exercises. It began by examining the growing vulnerability of water resources, including declining water availability, pollution, and climate-related disasters. Participants discussed how water insecurity affects health, education, and mental well-being, while also reflecting on challenges in their own communities. Jibesh KC from IWMI introduced different types of springs and the concept of springshed management, highlighting evidence of declining springs in Nepal, including the drying of approximately 20% of springs in Kavre over the past two decades. The discussion linked these changes to land-use change, deforestation, and climate variability and emphasised evidence-based, site-specific recharge interventions. As highlighted during the session, **"a recharge pond should only be built where the site has already been identified as a springshed."**

The session also introduced citizen science as a means of engaging communities and youth in water-related data collection, monitoring, advocacy, and technical innovation. Participants then took part in a practical demonstration of water-quality testing using the ENPHO P/A (H_2S) test kit to identify the presence or absence of coliform bacteria. Delegates were encouraged to apply the method in their own communities and share findings for follow-up. Local water challenges and potential solutions were also documented through a participatory exercise, contributing to subsequent discussions on provincial climate and water priorities.





Session 2: Khulla Aakash - Interrelating Climate Change and SRHR

Facilitator: Nabina Tiwari (YUWA), with support from Plan International Nepal.
The session examined the intersection of climate change and sexual and reproductive health and rights (SRHR), emphasising that climate change extends beyond environmental impacts and has differentiated consequences across gender and social groups. Using an online quiz and open discussion, participants reflected on which communities are most affected by climate change and how SRHR should be integrated into climate discourse. Discussions highlighted the disproportionate

impacts experienced by women, marginalised communities, and LGBTQIA+ groups. Participants repeatedly identified SRHR as an important but often overlooked dimension within broader discussions on gender equality, disability and social inclusion (GEDSI), underscoring the need to better integrate SRHR into climate policies and programmes.





Session 3: Integrating Climate Education and ACE into Nepalese Education Systems

Facilitators: Callie Fauntleroy and Dor Bahadur Yogi (UNICEF Nepal), supported by Lalita Tamang, Susmita Shrestha, and Aashmi KC (LCOY team). Participants: 29 youth delegates and 10–12 children from Creative Academy School.

The session explored how climate change is disrupting education and how Nepal's education system can become more climate-resilient, inclusive, and responsive. Participants began by sharing lived experiences of school closures, disrupted access, extreme heat, floods, landslides, and other climate-related hazards. Experiences included school flooding in Kathmandu, extreme heat disrupting schools in Madhesh, a flash flood damaging a bridge and restricting access to college, and extreme snowfall affecting school attendance. Participants also discussed wider impacts, including displacement risks, mental health concerns, air pollution, and increasing temperature and weather unpredictability.

Delegates and children then worked in groups across five thematic stations focusing on disaster- and climate-resilient infrastructure, curriculum and knowledge, education continuity during emergencies, teacher and student capacity, and climate financing and accountability. Discussions called for stronger regulation of school site selection and construction, inclusive infrastructure for children and persons with disabilities, geography-specific infrastructure standards, and effective enforcement of disaster-resilient building guidelines. Participants also emphasised integrating traditional and local knowledge into curricula, strengthening practical disaster-response education, improving teacher and student preparedness, and ensuring accessible early-warning systems and continuity mechanisms during emergencies. On financing, participants highlighted the need for greater domestic investment, transparency, public auditing, and community ownership of climate-related education funds.





Session 4: Understanding Loss and Damage and Just Transition

Facilitators: Santa Kumar Maharjan (Plan International Nepal and Prakriti Resource Centre), Pragya Sherchan and Suvekchhya Tuladhar (Prakriti Resource Centre and YUWA).

The session introduced delegates to loss and damage and just transition through participatory, card-based group work. Participants explored adaptation and mitigation alongside slow- and rapid-onset climate impacts, including drought, wetland drying, floods, and landslides. A Bardiya case highlighted the interconnected impacts of extreme heat, drying water sources, loss of life, human–wildlife conflict, forest fires, and agricultural losses.

Participants discussed economic and non-economic losses, including impacts on agriculture, infrastructure, employment, biodiversity, health, cultural identity, traditional knowledge, social cohesion, and human life. The session then explored just energy transition, focusing on benefit sharing, import substitution, GESI, grid connectivity, and FPIC. Barriers such as unfulfilled employment promises and consultation without meaningful consent were highlighted. Concerns around electric vehicle battery waste further emphasised the need for a transition grounded not only in emissions reduction, but also in environmental and social justice.





10.4 Plenary Session: Why Glacier Change Matters in the Himalaya

Speakers: Sangya Mishra and Sudan Bikash Maharjan, ICIMOD.

The session introduced glaciers, their formation and movement, and the equilibrium line as an indicator of glacier health. Speakers explained how rising temperatures and changing precipitation patterns are affecting the Hindu Kush Himalaya (HKH), which holds around 9% of the world's glaciers and feeds the Indus, Ganges, and Brahmaputra river systems. The discussion highlighted the upward movement of the rain line and shrinking snow line, with significant implications for water security and mountain communities.

Practical glacier monitoring was demonstrated using bamboo stakes drilled into the ice to measure surface change and mass balance over time. Nepal's glacial area has decreased by approximately 21% since 1920, while Yala Glacier has lost more than 66% of its mass since the 1970s. The session also examined glacier-related risks, particularly glacial lake outburst floods (GLOFs), through cases including the 2024 Thame event and thermokarst lake drainage in Rolwaling. Reflecting on the significance of glacier monitoring, the session emphasised that "a glacier is not simply ice", but a dynamic system whose changes provide important signals of climate and downstream risks. ICIMOD's long-term monitoring of Yala further demonstrates the value of field-based measurements for understanding these changes.

The session concluded by highlighting the relatively limited emphasis on glacier-related education in the region compared to Europe, identifying an opportunity for greater youth-led awareness, education, and engagement on cryosphere change.







10.5 Plenary: From NDC 3.0 to Climate Policy — Lessons for Strengthening Nepal's Climate Change Policy 2019

Facilitated by: Pragya Sherchan, Prakriti Resource Centre; Hemant Kandel and Dikshya Subedi from the Organizing team

The session examined Nepal's Climate Change Policy 2019 through a youth lens, beginning with a striking observation: youth are mentioned only four times and children just once in a policy intended to guide the country's response to the climate crisis. This was presented as both a measure of limited youth representation in climate governance and a benchmark for the policy currently under revision. With youth climate engagement in Nepal steadily growing, the session emphasised the need for this progress to be reflected more meaningfully in national policy.



The discussion identified key gaps, including the absence of meaningful youth participation during policy formulation, dedicated youth representation or focal points within climate governance structures, provisions addressing climate-induced youth migration, mandatory climate education, pathways to green employment, accessible youth climate finance, and youth and child specific monitoring indicators. These gaps were used to develop recommendations through a youth policy lab and survey, positioning young people as active reviewers rather than passive consultees. Key recommendations included institutionalizing youth participation in decision-making, establishing a youth focal person within the Climate Change Management Division, supporting youth-led local resilience initiatives, expanding green jobs and innovation, creating accessible youth climate finance mechanisms, investing in climate education, strengthening environmental review processes, and integrating Indigenous and local knowledge.

The session stressed that **"Nepal's difficulty has generally been a shortfall in implementation rather than a shortage of policy."** It concluded by highlighting the ongoing review and update of Nepal's NDCs as a timely opportunity to integrate youth priorities. Findings from the survey, thematic discussions, and policy review were to be consolidated into formal youth recommendations for submission to the Ministry of Agriculture, Forests and Environment.











11. Program and Activities | Day 2, 15 August 2026

Day 2 moved from baseline knowledge to contestation. The morning opened with reflections on Day 1, moderated by Nischal Dhungana and Aaska Aryal, in which delegates including Sarika Chand and Khushi Khanal described what they had learned about who is affected by climate change and how policy groups were divided.

11.1 Plenary: Climate Transparency and Youth

Speaker: Rajan Thapa, WWF Nepal, Project Manager, CBIT Project.

The session explored climate transparency as a foundation for meaningful youth engagement and climate accountability. Opening with the message **"see the reality, share the evidence, shape the future,"** Rajan Thapa challenged the idea that youth are merely the future, emphasising that they are already experiencing and responding to climate impacts. He also reframed youth from being seen as those who are **"always demanding"** to **"problem solvers,"** stressing that the success of LCOY would ultimately depend on how delegates engage with local governments, colleges, and policymaking processes beyond the conference.



The session defined transparency as more than publishing data: it requires making climate realities visible, understandable, and open to scrutiny. The speaker presented evidence of Nepal's changing climate, including rising temperatures, shifting rainfall and snowfall patterns, increasing vulnerability, and growing climate-related mortality. He highlighted the importance of understanding not only how much rain falls, but also its timing and duration, demonstrating how evidence can reveal risks that may otherwise remain invisible. He further emphasised that "the climate information gap is a power gap," as communities may experience changing hazards without having access to the information, resources, or decision-making processes needed to respond.

The discussion also highlighted non-economic losses that cannot be adequately captured through monetary valuation. Using the example of chauri herders in Upper Mustang, the speaker described how declining snowfall and shrinking grasslands have contributed to reduced chauri herding and youth outmigration, threatening the transmission of traditional songs, practices, and cultural knowledge between generations. This illustrated that climate loss extends beyond infrastructure and financial damage to include culture, identity, knowledge, and human lives.



The session proposed a transparency sequence of understanding the problem, its causes and impacts, available resources, actions taken, and progress achieved, while ensuring meaningful participation. Youth were encouraged to "listen, verify, amplify" by starting with realities on the ground and treating local knowledge as evidence. Digital tools, including mobile phones, were presented as practical accountability tools for mapping, verification, information sharing, and mobilisation. The speaker emphasised that youth engagement should go beyond making climate issues viral and instead focus on building informed, evidence-based action.





11.2 Parallel Session: Nothing About Us, Without Us - GEDSI and Youth Perspectives for Climate Justice

Panelists: Sulochana Khanal (WOREC), Jaldeep Sapkota (BYAN), and Aakriti Dotel (NYCA)
Moderator: Anju Pokharel (YAE)

Jaldeep Sapkota - Disability and Climate: Jaldeep Sapkota highlighted that persons with disabilities are often discussed in terms of basic needs such as food, shelter, and clothing, while their vulnerability, agency, and contribution to climate action receive limited attention. He identified access to information as a major barrier, particularly in early warning systems, noting that sirens and alarms are not accessible to everyone. He called for multiple communication methods, including visual alerts, phone vibrations, accessible design, and improved preparedness among rescue teams. He further stressed that accessibility must be integrated into infrastructure and planning from the beginning rather than added later, and that persons with disabilities should be recognised as stakeholders and contributors rather than beneficiaries. His central message was: **"Accessibility is a necessity, it is not a lottery."**



Sulochana Khanal - Gender, Disaster and Rescue: Sulochana Khanal discussed how climate and disaster impacts differ according to gender, resources, and geography, with women and girls facing increased risks of violence during and after disasters. She challenged the perception of communities as passive victims, noting that women within affected communities are often already involved in rescue and response but remain underrepresented in formal disaster management structures. She called for greater representation of women and youth in municipal and district disaster management committees and emphasised that response strategies must reflect diverse lived experiences and needs rather than applying a uniform approach. She also highlighted the importance of integrating sexual and reproductive health and rights (SRHR) into climate and disaster planning.

Aakriti Dotel — Local-Level Action and Policy: Aakriti Dotel emphasised that local climate concerns must be addressed at the local level and then carried upward through provincial, national, and international platforms. Drawing on NYCA's provincial chapter structure, she highlighted the need for youth focal points across different levels of government and stronger institutional capacity within local environmental structures. She also linked youth participation in climate action with political participation, arguing that when young people's voices are not adequately represented, they must consider entering policymaking spaces themselves. She encouraged delegates to advocate through evidence and lived experience while demonstrating effective domestic solutions rather than relying solely on external comparisons.

Discussion and Reflections: The floor discussion brought attention to gaps within existing GEDSI practices. A delegate questioned the absence of a child representative on a panel discussing issues affecting children, prompting the moderator to commit to strengthening child participation in future sessions. Other delegates raised the continued exclusion of SRHR, WASH, reproductive health, LGBTQIA+ communities, and persons with disabilities from climate and disaster discussions. Questions also focused on identifying and addressing gaps in disability inclusion. The session concluded with a reminder that "climate vulnerability is not equal," reinforcing the need for inclusive representation and climate action that responds to diverse experiences from the outset.





11.3 **Parallel Session:**

Session 1: Slow Poison in Our Food - Showcasing Agroecological Practices of Nepal

Facilitators: Prabin Bhattarai, Dipesh Nepal, and Namrata Bashyaula, Forest Action.

The session examined the health, environmental, and agricultural consequences of pesticide use, beginning with a 20 minute video followed by discussion and a practical exercise. The facilitators challenged the common perception of pesticides as "medicine" for crops, emphasising that pesticides are poisons and that their misuse can have serious long-term consequences. Cases from India, including the endosulfan crisis in Kasaragod and pesticide exposure in Bhopal and Punjab, were presented to illustrate impacts ranging from physical and neurological disorders to reproductive health problems, cancer, environmental contamination, and loss of agricultural diversity. These examples were connected to Nepal through reported pesticide residues and growing dependence on chemical inputs.



Discussion and Reflections: The floor discussion brought attention to gaps within existing GEDSI practices. A delegate questioned the absence of a child representative on a panel discussing issues affecting children, prompting the moderator to commit to strengthening child participation in future sessions. Other delegates raised the continued exclusion of SRHR, WASH, reproductive health, LGBTQIA+ communities, and persons with disabilities from climate and disaster discussions. Questions also focused on identifying and addressing gaps in disability inclusion. The session concluded with a reminder that "climate vulnerability is not equal," reinforcing the need for inclusive representation and climate action that responds to diverse experiences from the outset.





Session 2: ICJ Advisory Opinion on Climate Change and its Implications in Nepal

Facilitators: Shristi Gautam and Swikriti Timsina, World's Youth for Climate Justice (WYCJ) Nepal

The session introduced delegates to the International Court of Justice (ICJ) Advisory Opinion on climate change and its relevance to Nepal. It began with an interactive discussion asking whether climate change is a legal issue and how familiar participants were with the ICJ. The facilitators explained that the Advisory Opinion was sought to provide authoritative guidance on states' legal obligations regarding climate change and address gaps within existing international commitments.

Shristi Gautam and Swikriti Timsina outlined key implications of the Opinion, including greater accountability for high-emitting states and major emitters, stronger legal significance of the 1.5°C temperature threshold, and the need for states to align policies and NDC targets with their climate obligations. They also highlighted that climate responsibilities extend beyond climate law to human rights obligations, while accountability can apply to private actors and the fossil fuel industry through greater scrutiny of emission sources, licensing, and activities contributing to climate harm. The discussion also highlighted protections for states facing existential threats from climate impacts, linking these developments to broader questions of climate justice.



For Nepal, the session connected the Advisory Opinion to the country's high climate vulnerability despite its relatively low contribution to global emissions, emphasising the relevance of legal accountability, equity, and rights-based climate action. A video documenting the WYCJ campaign journey and process was also presented, demonstrating the role of youth-led advocacy in advancing the Advisory Opinion. The session concluded with a question-and-answer discussion on how these international legal developments can inform climate advocacy, policy engagement, and accountability in Nepal.





11.4 Group Work: Grassroots Climate Hardships Across All Seven Provinces

Facilitators: Dibya Acharya and Bhumika Pandey, with province-wise note-taking by the organising team.

Delegates were grouped by province and worked through a structured set of questions to identify local climate and environmental issues, their underlying causes, impacts, and possible solutions. The exercise highlighted both shared and province-specific challenges across Nepal.

Sudurpaschim Province



- **Issue:** Illegal and excessive extraction of sand, stone, and other construction materials from rivers, increasing flood risk.
- **Causes:** Monsoon-season extraction, weak monitoring, and irrigation canal issues.
- **Impacts:** Increased river degradation and flooding.
- **Proposed solutions:** Strengthen river management and monitoring, implement large-scale plantation programmes, and promote planned rural development.

Karnali Province

- **Issue:** Food insecurity and agricultural vulnerability.
- **Causes:** Difficult terrain, inadequate infrastructure, youth out-migration, and limited youth participation in agriculture.
- **Impacts:** Seasonal food shortages, malnutrition, and livelihood poverty.
- **Proposed solutions:** Promote indigenous climate-resilient crops, improve transportation and irrigation, engage youth in agriculture, and strengthen climate-resilient agrifood systems.



Madhesh Province

- **Issue:** Severe environmental and agricultural challenges, including groundwater depletion, drought, and irregular rainfall, leading to food insecurity and import dependence.
- **Causes:** Lack of groundwater recharge systems, insufficient infrastructure, and a shortage of resources, trained personnel, and farmer training.
- **Impacts:** Widespread food insecurity and increased reliance on imports.
- **Proposed Solutions:** Develop better infrastructure, provide technical support, and prioritize skill development and capacity building for farmers

Lumbini Province

- **Issue:** Rising temperatures and air pollution.
- **Causes:** Increasing carbon emissions and continued dependence on firewood.
- **Impacts:** Heat waves disrupting daily life and education, and worsening air pollution.
- **Proposed solutions:** Raise public awareness, enforce environmental regulations, and expand access to cleaner energy alternatives.
- **Youth perspective:** Jigyasha B.K. shared how flooding resulted in the loss of food and agricultural products in her community.

Koshi Province

- **Issue:** Industrial pollution, contaminated water sources, poor waste management, and recurring floods.
- **Causes:** Habitat loss, prolonged drought, extreme heat, forest fires, and increasing human–elephant conflict.
- **Impacts:** Agricultural losses, property damage, and human casualties, with marginalised communities disproportionately affected.
- **Proposed solutions:** Strengthen public awareness, establish early warning systems and rapid response teams, and promote community forestry.





Bagmati Province

- **Issue:** Urban flooding, water insecurity, human–animal conflict, and environmental degradation linked to rapid urbanisation.
- **Causes:** Unplanned infrastructure development, land concretisation, weak urban governance, carbon pollution, and increasingly intense rainfall.
- **Impacts:** Water scarcity, biodiversity loss, urban heat islands, poor waste management, and physical and mental health impacts.
- **Proposed solutions:** Enforce land-use planning and IEE/EIA provisions, promote rainwater harvesting, revive traditional water systems, and strengthen citizen science and research collaboration.

Gandaki Province

- **Issue:** Shrinking lake areas, changing precipitation patterns, and increasing population pressure.
- **Causes:** Rapid urbanisation, deforestation, and global warming.
- **Impacts:** Air pollution, accelerated snowmelt, heat waves, and crop failures affecting livelihoods.
- **Proposed solutions:** Establish early warning systems, promote eco-friendly and climate-resilient infrastructure, develop adaptation plans for vulnerable communities, and support sustainable tourism.



11.5 Mock COP Simulation: Understanding Climate Negotiations from Nepal's Perspective

Facilitators: Hemant Kandel, Kirtan Pandit, Hemanshu Kafle and Sneha Uprety

The Mock COP simulation was designed to give delegates a practical understanding of climate negotiations, consensus-building, and strategic trade-offs using a hypothetical draft decision. The exercise deliberately departed from traditional Model United Nations formats by enforcing the strict COP consensus model, where a single objecting party can block a text, compelling delegates to actively negotiate rather than out-vote opponents. Nine distinct negotiating blocs, including the **Mountain Group, G77 and China, AILAC, the LDC Group, the Arab Group, the African Group, the European Union, Australia, and the LMDCs**, participated in the exercise armed with bracketed texts and private instructions.





As organizers, we structured the simulation around the core mechanics of international climate diplomacy, forcing participants to navigate complex text-based bargaining rather than writing decisions from scratch. Delegates were tasked with closing brackets by managing opening positions, fallbacks, and red lines distributed across their bloc briefs. This design compelled them to engage in rigorous cross-bloc alliances, master the art of strategic concessions, and understand how procedural rules and financial contingencies can shape the ultimate strength and outcome of a global climate decision.





11.6 **Parallel Session**

Parallel Workshop 1: Pitching for Climate Finance, Seeking Possible Solutions for Local Climate Challenges Session

Facilitated by: Hemanshu Kafle and the Organizing team

The workshop challenged eight groups to translate grassroots environmental problems into fundable, 12 months project proposals within a strict 60 minute timeframe. Working from standardized project canvases, pitch cards, peer scorecards, and a reference sheet of 32 youth and grassroots climate funds, participants had to distill their initiatives into concise 90-second pitches evaluated by their peers on five core criteria: urgency, specificity, stated change, community roots, and clarity.

The facilitator guided the room through the mechanics of effective donor pitching, highlighting why proposals typically fail, such as describing activities without naming concrete changes, asking for unspecified funding amounts, or wasting precious time on background information. Four completed project canvases were collected, showcasing distinct local challenges, innovative problem-solving approaches, and the common hurdles young climate innovators face when approaching donors:





- **Pokhari Pulse** focused on reviving traditional ponds and stone spouts in the Kathmandu Valley to mitigate flood and drought risks. While it stood out as the most technically rigorous proposal integrating engineering designs with indigenous Guthi institutional knowledge and an open source replication manual its execution was undermined by an inconsistent financial ask, displaying conflicting figures and currencies across its canvas and pitch card.

- **Waste to Worth** targeted poor waste management and segregation along the Hanumante Khola corridor in Kageshwori Manohara Municipality through community trainings and terrace farming initiatives. It delivered the strongest and most measurable impact statement of the session (reducing visible waste dumping), fitting neatly within grant windows like Roots Microgrants or the Spark Fund, though it omitted naming a target fund on its canvas.

- **Jaldiwan** tackled invasive water hyacinth choking the Jagdishpur Tal wetland by converting harvested biomass into extracted fiber for ropes, mats, and baskets. Representing the cleanest fund match of the workshop, it aligned perfectly with the Youth4Climate: Call for Solutions ceiling of USD 30,000 and offered the most bulletproof defense against critical funder inquiries by positioning the weed as a flexible raw material.

- **Climate Resilient and Sustainable Vegetable Enterprise**, Bharatpur designed a sophisticated blended finance model for 200 smallholder farmers facing erratic rainfall, splitting its large NRs 5,000,000 ask evenly across a donor fund, local government, and the farmers themselves. Despite its strong baseline context and community backing, the proposal faltered because it left its 12 month change unstated and requested an amount far exceeding the ceiling of the target fund it selected.

Parallel Workshop 2: People's Hearing for Climate Justice, Challenging the Wrongdoers With Our Bold Voices

Moderated By: Bhumika Pandey and the Organizing Team

The workshop engaged delegates in an adversarial role-playing exercise built around an environmental impact assessment (EIA) for a large infrastructure project, using the contentious Nijgadh airport proposal as a reference case. Participants were assigned specific stakeholder roles—including government stakeholders, affected communities, civil society organizations (CSOs) and activists, and youth groups—to argue their respective perspectives through a simulated public hearing format:





- **Government stakeholders** defended the project by asserting that a formal EIA was complete, the designated site involved minimal impact, and post-construction tree planting would benefit locals. They emphasized that the project cleared all three tiers of government, promised ongoing compensation, and would reduce congestion at Tribhuvan International Airport while creating local jobs.

- **Affected communities** pushed back by highlighting their total reliance on the forest and questioning why their land was targeted over alternatives. They challenged authorities on cultural preservation, criticized the government for favoring private interests, and countered with a proposal to develop tourism routes instead.

- **CSOs and activists** questioned the validity of the EIA and the justification for displacing indigenous populations without prior consent. They highlighted critical timing gaps, noting that newly planted trees take decades to replace mature forests, while challenging habitat loss and citizen rights.

- **Youth groups** argued that artificial tree planting cannot restore lost biodiversity and that the state should instead prioritize upgrading existing public infrastructure like schools and hospitals. They also introduced a demographic critique, arguing that a massive international airport facilitating outward migration accelerates local population loss.

The session concluded with a reflective discussion on the dual role humans play as both protectors and destroyers of the environment, reinforcing that constructive coordination between local populations and government authorities is completely unavoidable. Delegates walked away recognizing that high-stakes public hearings demand rigorous, evidence-based answers to tough questions, ultimately demonstrating how diverse sectors negotiate toward problem-solving and where meaningful youth engagement fits within national decision-making.



11.7 Panel Discussion : Beyond the Table, Opportunities, Barriers and the Future of Youth in Climate Governance in Nepal

Panelists: Pragya Devkota (World Food Forum Nepal), Satish Karn (Welthungerhilfe), Binod Deuba Thakuri (Gen Z activist), Jyotsna Basnet (Practical Action Nepal)
Moderated by: Dikshya Subedi (Founder, YASEN) with Bishnu Pandey (Nepal Youth Network)



The panel explored the complex landscape of youth participation, systemic barriers, and structural governance in Nepal's climate movement through diverse perspectives from institutional leads, field practitioners, and youth activists:

- **Pragya Devkota (World Food Forum Nepal):** Pragya Devkota emphasized food security as an immediate casualty of climate shocks, noting that shifting youth perceptions of farming requires treating young people as strategic partners and financial decision-makers rather than passive beneficiaries. She highlighted climate-resilient startups as practical entry points for youth-led climate finance.

- **Binod Deuba Thakuri (Gen Z activist):** Binod Deuba argued that climate change is fundamentally a political issue intrinsically tied to good governance, criticizing the siloed treatment of environmental ministries and the persistent lack of budget integration. He also challenged internal inequalities within the movement, pointing out Kathmandu-centric privilege, stagnant leadership pipelines where the same faces repeatedly attend COP, and the systemic hurdles preventing true representation.

- **Satish Karn (WeltHungerHilfe Nepal):** Satish Karn addressed the prevalence of tokenistic empowerment, urging young people to actively demand seats at local and national tables through eco-clubs, ward mechanisms, and funding proposals. He reframed migration around equity, stressing that structural gaps, such as unpaid internships and lack of domestic assets, force unsafe migration out of necessity.

- **Jyotsna Basnet (Practical Action Nepal):** Jyotsna Basnet critiqued traditional project designs for over-indexing on physical infrastructure while neglecting community sustainability ("software") after project timelines expire. Advocating for a co-partner model, she underscored platforms like Local Conference of Youth (LCOY) as vital spaces for cross-provincial knowledge sharing and bridging grassroots realities with institutional policy.

During the rapid-fire segment, panelists defined climate justice through inclusive decision-making, favored the energy of the street over the table, and identified tokenism as the single greatest obstacle facing youth advocacy.



Floor discussions further interrogated systemic hurdles, ranging from inaccessible donor funding mechanisms and quality education gaps to the risk of youth voices being diluted by donor, driven "future-leader" framing.

The day concluded with evening networking, dinner, and a cultural night that delegates later celebrated as a conference highlight.





12. Program and Activities | Day 3, 16 August 2026

The day was moderated by Nischal Raj Gautam and Kritika Laudari, who opened on the line that youth are not only the future but the present. Reflections on Day 2 from the floor centred on the mock COP and negotiation learning, the cultural night, and the debate. One child delegate said simply that she got to learn about climate change.

12.1 Group Work: From Policy to Action-Advancing Youth-Centred Climate Governance

Facilitator: Bal Krishna Jamarkattel and the Organizing Team

The session explored how Nepal can translate NDC 3.0 commitments into meaningful, locally grounded climate action with children and youth as active participants. Opening with culturally diverse greetings including Namaskar, Pranam, Jojolapa, Sewa, and Sewaro—the discussion highlighted the disproportionate impacts of climate change on young people and the need for their meaningful participation in climate governance, planning, and decision-making.

Building on **Hon. Minister Geeta Chaudhary's** commitment to meaningful youth engagement and **Maheshwor Dhakal's** proposal for an informal YOUNGO-style structure, participants proposed establishing **at least two Climate Champions at every local level**, aligned with NDC 3.0. The champions would mobilise local climate action, connect grassroots voices with policymakers, and support effective utilisation of local government resources. Participants emphasised clear selection criteria, community consultation, leadership and communication skills, and a formal mechanism positioning Climate Champions as supportive partners to local governments. The discussion also highlighted climate-resilient education, green jobs, innovation, research, and measurable targets supported by disaggregated data.





Provincial groups identified priorities for a youth participation platform: **overall development (Sudurpashchim and Madhesh), inclusivity (Karnali), meaningful participation (Lumbini), inclusion with capacity building (Gandaki), entrepreneurship and market access (Bagmati), and alignment with political processes (Koshi).** The facilitator further emphasised mobilisation, capacity building, policy monitoring and evaluation, and mainstreaming children's and young people's voices in policymaking.



Thematic Group Inputs

- **Climate Education and ACE:** Clear budget allocation; climate mapping; inclusion of five persons with disabilities to strengthen inclusive empowerment; and promotion of informal education.
- **Water Security and WASH:** Mandate-specific conservation provisions; integration of research; and greater emphasis on scientific evidence and technology.
- **Loss and Damage:** Inclusion of persons with disabilities and recognition and accounting of non-economic losses.
- **Climate Finance:** Proper utilisation of local resources; compulsory inclusion of Corporate Social Responsibility (CSR); and ensuring climate finance reaches the ground level.
- **Changing Mountains and Livelihoods:** Innovative integration of disaster risk reduction (DRR) and mechanisms to channel migration remittances towards adaptation funding.
- **Agriculture:** Post-harvest mapping; integration of remote sensing and AI; development of food zones; promotion of traditional knowledge; and adoption of circular economy approaches.
- **Gender Equality, Disability and Social Inclusion (GEDSI):** Accessible, inclusive, and commonly adaptable spaces; inclusion of diverse disability groups in policymaking; and establishment of an equitable platform for meaningful participation.

Overall, the session emphasised that youth-centred climate governance must move from recognition to meaningful participation and from policy commitments to measurable local action, supported by disaggregated data, dedicated resources, inclusive institutions, capacity building, and accountability.





12.2 **Plenary: Beyond LCOY Nepal 2026 - From Dialogue to Action**

Speaker: Manjeet Dhakal, Climate Analytics Nepal

The plenary was conducted as an interactive dialogue, challenging delegates to question assumptions and support their climate claims with evidence. Beginning with personal responsibility and carbon footprints, the discussion moved to international emissions and climate justice, emphasising that the focus should not simply be on "who is at fault," but on whether development is sustainable.

Using the 2024 Kathmandu flood as a case, participants reflected on heavy rainfall, infrastructure, and risk-sensitive planning, highlighting the need to avoid construction on floodplains. The discussion also challenged assumptions about Nepal's environmental progress, particularly forest cover, stressing the significant role of community forestry and the importance of evidence-based claims: "When we comment, we need to look for evidence-based papers."





The session further explored the unintended consequences of climate solutions, including hydropower impacts and battery waste from electric vehicles. Delegates shared local examples of action, including waste segregation and methane recovery in Dhangadhi, micro-hydro and clean energy initiatives, early warning systems, and a sanitation and resource centre in Syangja. The improved visibility of Everest from Chandragiri during the COVID-19 lockdown was also cited as evidence of human-induced air pollution.

The session concluded with a call to share Nepal's successful local practices internationally to attract investment and partnerships, while reinforcing the central message: "Development and sustainability have to move together."

12.3 **Parallel Session:**

Session 1: Relating Social Entrepreneurship to the Young Generation
Speaker: Anu Joshi Shrestha, ICIMOD

The session introduced social entrepreneurship as the development of financially sustainable business models that address social or environmental challenges. Moving beyond traditional business and charity, social enterprises aim to create lasting economic, social, and environmental value, expressed through the principle: "Social or environmental purpose plus business model equals sustainable impact."



Delegates overwhelmingly agreed that climate change can create opportunities for young entrepreneurs. A live poll identified key community-level impacts, including water insecurity and drying springs, erratic rainfall, heat stress, food insecurity, waste management challenges, declining soil health, and increasing agricultural pests. These challenges were reframed as potential opportunities for innovation and enterprise.

The session highlighted four questions for turning problems into viable solutions: Who experiences the problem? What do they actually need? Who pays for the solution? How can we test it? Potential areas for youth-led social enterprises in Nepal included resilient tourism and culture, climate-smart agriculture, water and WASH, nature-based enterprises, and clean energy.

The session concluded with a shift in mindset from simply identifying problems to developing practical solutions: "The question is not what business should I start, it is what problem can I solve?"





Session 2: Youth Stories

Moderator: Prakash Lama

The session explored how personal experiences and opportunities can shape young people's climate journeys. Prakash Lama opened by asking whether a story is enough to inspire before sharing his own journey—from initially pursuing medicine to studying environmental science, becoming involved in street advocacy and campaigns, attending COY, and eventually working with the government on mitigation policy. He highlighted how a single climate negotiation session opened new opportunities, emphasising that "one session opened the door."

Lama also highlighted the need for greater legal expertise among climate advocates and reflected on the limitations of NDC 3.0. He presented seven youth demands for the National Climate Change Policy: mountain agenda, capacity building, active engagement, connections, global mobility, governance, and research mobilisation. He stressed that youth must mobilise the demands they raise from their own spaces and concluded that "success is not a destination but a journey."

Delegate Stories

- Kaushal Niraula: Began his climate engagement through NYCA in Grade 8 and helped establish the NYCA Biratnagar Chapter. He has since shifted from an activism-focused approach towards research-based advocacy, including work with YUWA and research on climate anxiety supported by the British Council.



The process emphasised collective ownership of the statement, ensuring that it was not simply prepared on behalf of children and youth, but shaped through their direct participation and contributions. Through discussion, feedback, and refinement, participants worked towards a final statement that consolidated their shared concerns, priorities, and demands for climate action in Nepal.

The finalised National Children and Youth Statement on Climate Change 2026 was then formally announced during the closing plenary as a collective outcome of LCOY Nepal 2026.





12.5 **Closing Plenary and Announcement of the National Children and Youth Statement**

The closing plenary brought together reflections from children, youth representatives, partners, and organisers on the three-day LCOY Nepal 2026 experience. A **Class 8 child representative** shared her appreciation for being included, noting that she initially viewed the programme as a chore but left having met new people and learned about climate change and transparency. She recommended that future programmes continue to provide meaningful spaces for children.

Roshni Adhikari of BYAN thanked the organisers and participants for creating an inclusive platform, while stressing that inclusion should not become a tokenistic exercise and encouraging delegates to reach out to those who were not represented.

Manashree Newa of ICIMOD encouraged delegates to recognise their collective achievement and take the learning back to their communities. She highlighted two key foundations for evidence-based advocacy: lived experience and research, pointing to Himal Talk as an accessible resource for further learning.

Srijana Gurung, Acting Country Director of Plan International Nepal, reflected on the energy, diversity, and depth of discussions throughout the conference, concluding that **"LCOY itself is not the journey, it is one scale of the journey."**





Aakriti Dotel, Focal Point, formally closed the conference by thanking delegates for their active participation and urging them to share the outcomes within their communities. She emphasised that the success of LCOY depends on delegates carrying its messages and voices to the **ground level**.

The closing plenary concluded with the **finalization and announcement of the National Children and Youth Statement on Climate Change 2026**, where the draft and finalization process was facilitated by Hemant Kandel, and followed by certificate distribution and a group photograph, marking the conclusion of LCOY Nepal 2026 and the beginning of its implementation journey.











13. Outcomes of LCOY Nepal 2026

Short-term outcomes

- Delegates from all seven provinces convened for a three-day residential conference, preceded by nine virtual consultations that gathered climate concerns and recommendations from around 180 delegates.
- The National Children and Youth Statement on Climate Change 2026 was drafted, finalised and announced at the closing plenary, for submission to the Government of Nepal and transmission to YOUNGO for the Global Youth Statement ahead of COP 31 in Antalya.
- A direct commitment from the Honourable Minister for Agriculture, Forests and Environment that youth voices will be taken into every stage of policy and to COP 31, together with an open invitation to delegates to bring their findings to the ministry for policy discussion.
- Baseline knowledge established across seven thematic areas through expert-led sessions with UNICEF, WWF Nepal, ICIMOD, Clean Energy Nepal, Prakriti Resource Centre, Plan International Nepal, Forest Action, IWMI, YUWA, WOREC, BYAN, WYCJ, WFF Nepal, Welthungerhilfe and Practical Action Nepal.
- Practical skills transferred rather than only discussed: water quality testing with ENPHO P/A kits distributed for use in delegates' own localities with follow-up reporting; springshed and recharge siting; citizen science methods; consensus-based negotiation through the mock COP; adversarial public hearing technique; and the social enterprise problem-framing method.
- Province-wise documentation of grassroots climate hardship, covering issues, causes, effects and proposed solutions, generated by delegates from their own localities.
- A concrete institutional proposal, at least two Climate Champions per local level, with delegate-generated selection criteria and role definition ready for local government engagement.
- Children participated directly, in the opening plenary, in parallel sessions and in the closing plenary, and their exclusion from the GEDSI panel was raised by delegates, accepted by the organisers and committed to for future editions.

Long-term outcomes

- Sustained youth engagement in national climate policy and decision-making, including the review and implementation of climate policies.
- Strengthened youth-led climate action at provincial and local levels, supported by the proposed Climate Champions mechanism.
- Increased use of evidence, citizen science and local knowledge in youth climate advocacy and community-level action.
- Greater integration of climate-resilient education, WASH, food systems, mountain livelihoods, loss and damage, just transition and GEDSI into youth-led climate action.
- Stronger accountability and transparency in climate finance and implementation, with youth and communities contributing to monitoring.
- Continued contribution of Nepalese children and youth voices to YOUNGO, COY and COP processes, including COP31 and future international climate negotiations.
- A stronger and more inclusive, decentralised and action-oriented youth climate movement in Nepal.

14. Environmental Sustainability

LCOY Nepal 2026 applied the following practices across the planning and delivery of the event:

- Minimal use of single-use plastics, with fibre-based banners and eco-friendly materials throughout.
- Promotion of local food and products, and reduction of food waste, with delegates asked in the Code of Conduct to encourage food safety and avoid wasting food provided at the venue.
- Coordination of shared transport for delegates travelling from common locations, and promotion of public transport.
- Wooden crafts rather than plastic gifts presented to speakers and experts as tokens of appreciation.
- Digital distribution of event materials, including the delegate handbook and session materials, to reduce paper use.
- Optimal use of logistics and venue resources.

15. Conclusion

LCOY Nepal 2026 was built on a specific bet: that the most useful thing a youth climate conference can do is not raise awareness but raise the standard of evidence young people bring to the table. The theme, "Together for Climate Transparency", was carried into practice through sessions that gave delegates numbers they could cite, methods they could use and cases they could name.
By the end of the three days, delegates could describe Nepal's warming rate and its variation by region, the mechanics of glacial lake formation and the losses from the Thame event, why 20 percent of Kavre's springs have dried and where a recharge pond should and should not be built, the distinction between economic and non-economic loss and why cultural heritage sits in the second category, what the ICJ advisory opinion changes about state obligation, and how consensus decision-making at COP differs from majority voting. They could also test their own water and report the result.

The conference was equally clear about its own limits. A delegate asked why there was no child on the panel discussing children, and the organisers accepted the criticism rather than deflecting it. A delegate named the people missing from every inclusion list, including those living on the street. Panelists named the privilege inside the youth climate movement itself: that the same faces travel to COP, that leadership is not transferred, and that media attention concentrates on Kathmandu while activity happens across the country. These were not comfortable observations, and they belong in the record precisely because they are the work that remains.

The National Children and Youth Statement on Climate Change 2026 now moves to the Government of Nepal, into the review of the National Climate Change Policy 2019, and to YOUNGO for the Global Youth Statement ahead of COP 31 in Antalya. The Minister's invitation to bring findings to the ministry for discussion is an opening, and openings close. As the focal point told delegates in the closing plenary, the success of this conference is determined at ground level, not in the hall.

16. Way Forward

Learnings for LCOY Nepal 2027.

- Strengthen post-LCOY follow-up and accountability to track implementation of the National Children and Youth Statement.
- Ensure meaningful and diverse participation, particularly of children, persons with disabilities and marginalised communities.
- Strengthen provincial and grassroots engagement and decentralise climate leadership beyond Kathmandu.
- Improve evidence-based advocacy by linking youth experiences with research, data and citizen science.
- Establish clearer mechanisms for youth engagement in policy-making and climate governance at all levels.
- Ensure every LCOY recommendation has a clear action point, responsible stakeholder and follow-up mechanism.
- Make LCOY 2027 more inclusive, transparent, accessible and action-oriented.

TEAM behind **SUCCESS !**

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युवा पहल
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NETWORKING PARTNERS

ForestAction
JCYCN 2001 Jagriti Child and Youth Concern Nepal
National Indigenous Disabled Women Association Nepal 2015 NIDWAN
SHE changes climate

INCLUSION PARTNER

BYAN Blind Youth Association Nepal
cbm global disability inclusion

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Clean Energy Nepal
Youth Alliance for Environment

SUSTAINABILITY PARTNERS

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Hoste Hainse Sustainable Community Development through Education
Kanduk
Nepal Youth Network for Sustainable Development दिगो विकासका लागि राष्ट्रिय युवा सञ्जाल

EDUCATION PARTNER

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GEDSI PARTNER

WOREC Women's Rehabilitation Centre Nepal 1991

Our Youth Partners









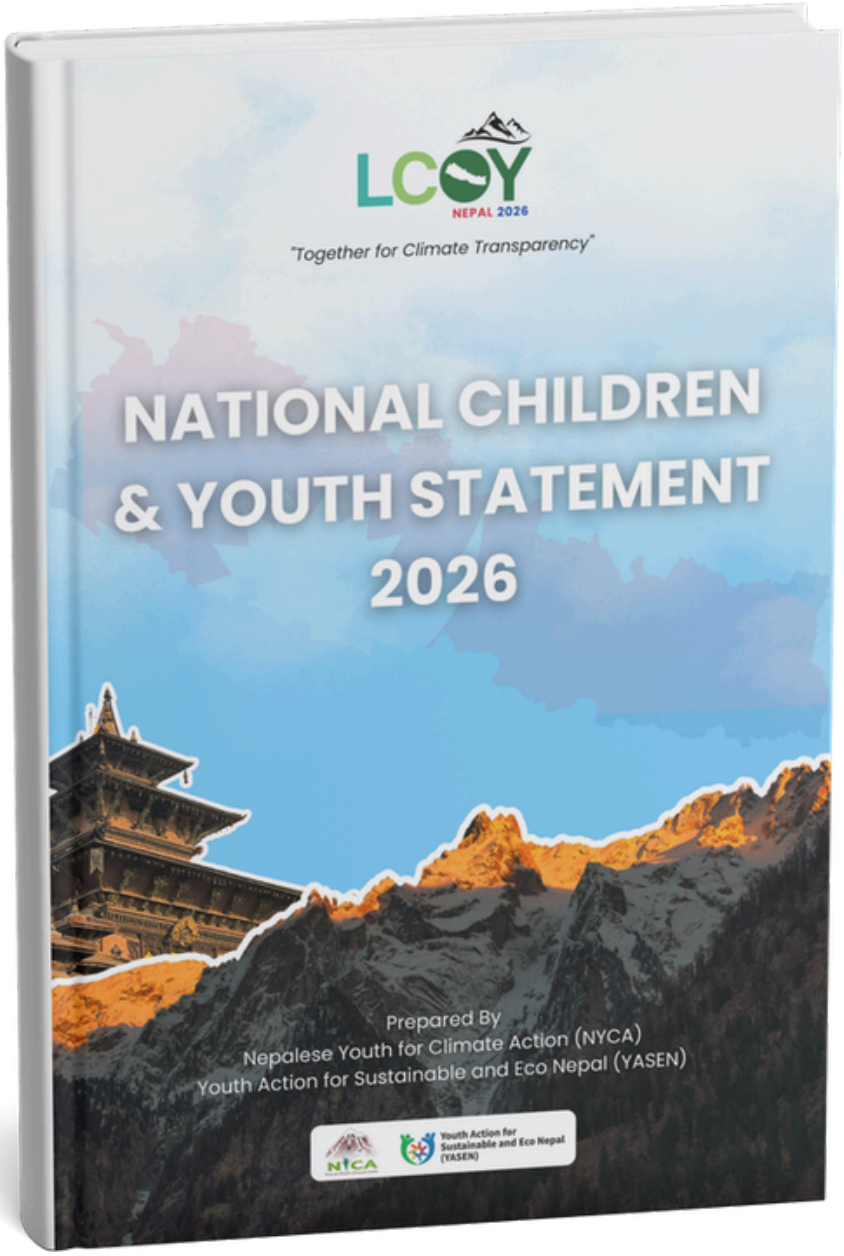








National Children & Youth Statement on Climate Change



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